

Apply to be a Science Corps Fellow - Entry #3366

Name
Larry Ger Aragon
Email
larrygeraragon30@gmail.com
Gender
Male
Residence: City (State), Country
Melbourne (VIC), Australia
Nationality
Filipino
When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD?
January 2026
Please tell us briefly about your university education (institution, city, country, year)
I will be completing my Joint PhD in Atmospheric Science from the University of Melbourne (Australia) and the University of Manchester (United Kingdom) in January 2026. I obtained an MS in Atmospheric Science from Ateneo De Manila University (Philippines) in 2020. I hold a BS in Meteorology from Central Luzon State University (Philippines) in 2014, where I was part of the pioneering batch of the Philippines' first BS Meteorology program, a project supported by the Philippine Government among four state universities in the country.
Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow?
My desire to be a Science Corps Fellow is deeply rooted in my identity as a Filipino scientist. My home country, the Philippines, is on the front lines of climate change impacts, annually visited and often ravaged by typhoons. This firsthand experience drives my commitment to promote weather science and contribute meaningfully to local climate change awareness, especially to the next generation of Filipinos. The fellowship's focus on the Philippines in 2026 presents a significant opportunity for me to contribute directly and meaningfully to my home country. My goal as a Fellow would be to develop and implement teaching modules that can integrate modern tools like Python and GIS into meteorology and climate change studies, tailored specifically to Philippine contexts. Beyond curriculum development, I can also leverage my existing network at the national weather agency (DOST-PAGASA), local research institutes like the Manila Observatory, and universities with meteorology programs to build lasting collaborations for Science Corps. This motivation is grounded in my past work. Prior to my PhD, I was part of the Philippine Government's 'Science Explorer' program, traveling to remote schools with fellow early-career scientists to introduce various fields of science to grade and high school students. After introducing Weather Science, at the end of every talk, I made it a

point to share information on local scholarships to show them a tangible path in their tertiary education. Having been a government scholar myself since my undergraduate studies, my journey is proof that poverty is not a hindrance to success for a diligent student given the right opportunity. I want to bring not just technical expertise to the fellowship, but also the drive to inspire young Filipinos by showing them a relatable path to unlocking and achieving their own dreams in science.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science Corps Fellow.

My prior experiences have prepared me to contribute meaningfully to the Science Corps Fellowship. In terms of teaching, I have experience making the high-level science of Meteorology and Atmospheric Science accessible to a wide range of audiences. As part of the Philippines' 'Science Explorer' program, I prepared interactive modules in Weather Science that grade and high school students could easily understand and appreciate. At the university level, I have taught undergraduate meteorology courses at Bicol University, where I developed and delivered coursework in computational methods for Meteorology using Python and Data Analytics.

In terms of research, my capacity is demonstrated by four internationally published papers. I have also supervised two undergraduate theses and served as a panel member for four others with varied topics across my field.

My professional background and nationality are also assets to the fellowship. As a Filipino scholar who has studied at top universities worldwide, I bring a unique perspective that blends global methodologies in Atmospheric Science with problems relevant to the Philippine context. I understand the specific hurdles facing young, underprivileged but highly capable Filipino students, as I was once like that myself, and I am passionate about using my experience and professional network to inspire them. I am also eager to contribute my insights, in whatever way I can, to help meet the mission of the Science Corps.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Scientist in academia

Doing science in industry

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

In the near term (~2 years), my professional goal is to broaden my research expertise into more applied meteorological and climate research. I am particularly interested in exploring renewable energy resource assessment and the application of deep learning to satellite remote sensing. This aligns perfectly with my ongoing collaborations with other early-career researchers in the Philippines, where we are working on independent projects related to heat extremes, radar meteorology, and AI applications using weather satellites. I also intend to apply for the Philippine government's "Balik Scientist" (Returning Scientist) program when eligible, to formalize my contributions and pursue funded meteorological research in the country.

In the long term (~10 years), I see myself in a senior scientific role, either as a tenured scientist or professor in academia or as a senior climate data scientist in industry. While my passion for fundamental research remains strong, I am also keenly aware that many pressing business and societal problems require scientific solutions. I want to be in a position to apply my expertise to these challenges and am committed to constantly developing my technical and leadership skills to remain relevant in whichever path I take. My atmospheric science background is

directly applicable to these areas, especially as climate change adaptation, renewable energy, and net-zero solutions become more established.

Please upload your CV (.pdf)[v2_CV_Aragon_Aug2025.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

Referred by a friend/colleague/supervisor in academia

Other

[Science Corps](#)